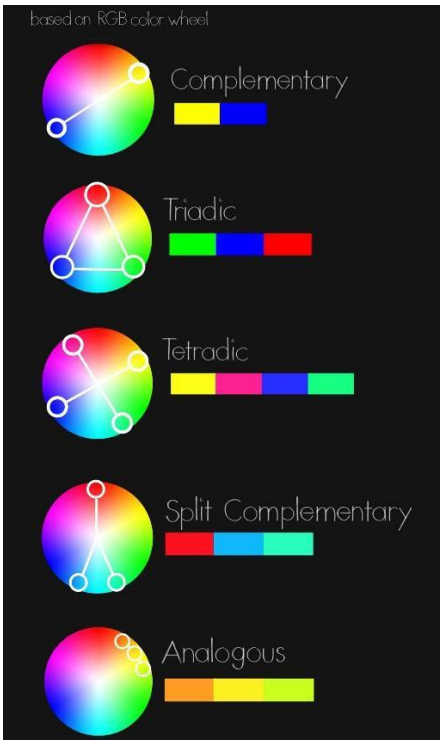
Diploma in Lightroom

Exploring the Worlds of Colour & Black & White

Colour Theory and Colour Harmonies

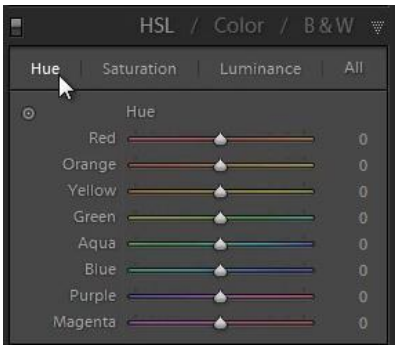
White light when split reveals that it is made up of 3 primary colours – Red, Green and Blue. It is through different combinations of these colours that we see other colours that make up the visible spectrum. (Please note that the primary colours of light are not the same as the primary colours of pigment)
Certain colours will work together very well, in what is known as colour harmony. There are many different types of colour harmony but all are based of the RGB colour wheel. Understanding these harmonies will help you to create stunning photos when you can control the colour in the shot!

Here are some basic Harmonies:



What is the HSL Module?

HSL stands for “Hue,” “Saturation,” and “Luminance,” which you can see when you expand the panel. Hue deals with the actual colour tones of the image, like shifting colour tones to a different tonal range. Saturation deals with the power or the saturation of a specific colour while Luminance deals with the brightness of a certain colour in the image.



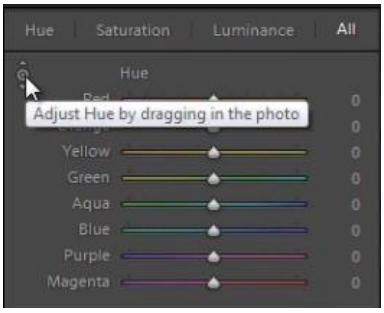
To adjust Hue, Saturation or Luminance individually, simply click on whichever of those you want to adjust. We also have the option to view all 3 at once by clicking on “All.”

ADJUSTING THE HUE IN THE HSL SECTION OF THE HSL/COLOR/B&W PANEL

We have different Hues in our images and when we adjust the Hues sliders we will affect the tonal range of each colour. For example, if we want to affect the Blues in our image, we can drag the slider for Blue

to the left or right. Dragging the slider to the left will make the Blues in our image greener, whereas dragging the slider to the right will increase the purple in our image.

We can also use the Adjustment Point Tool to adjust the Hues in our image. In fact, Hue, Saturation and Luminance all have an Adjustment Point Tool. This tool can be found at the top left.

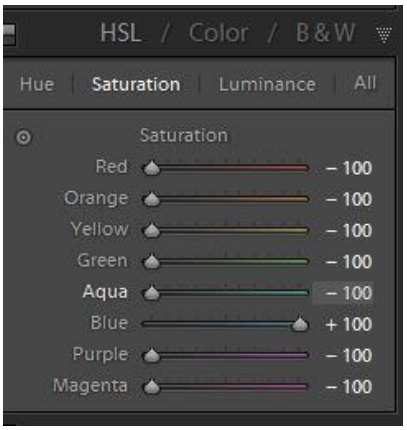


When we select this tool, we can go anywhere in our image and pick a specific colour. We can click and pull the Hue Adjustment Point Tool up or down and the tool will adjust that colour.

ADJUSTING THE SATURATION IN THE HSL SECTION OF THE HSL/COLOR/B&W PANEL

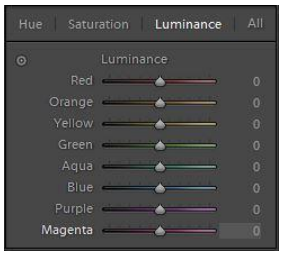
The most effective way to adjust the saturation of each colour is with the Saturation Adjustment Point Tool. Similarly to the Hue tool, we can use the slider to change the look of our image. When we have the Saturation Adjustment Point Tool selected, any area of the image that we are hovering over will highlight the colour in the panel that will be affected.

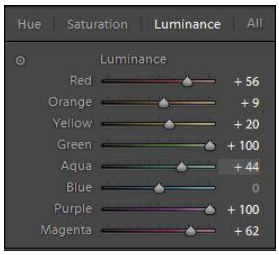
If we want to use the little circle and hover over a specific colour to adjust it, make sure to click on it first. To adjust the saturation, click on an area of the image with the Saturation Adjustment Point Tool and drag up or down. To add more saturation, drag the Saturation Adjustment Point Tool up, and to decrease the saturation, drag the tool down. When we adjust the saturation, only the area we select will change. In the image below, we have desaturated all the colours except for the blue



ADJUSTING THE LUMINANCE IN THE HSL SECTION OF THE HSL/COLOR/B&W PANEL

The Luminance deals with the actual brightness levels of the different colours. You can use this tool to increase the tonal separation of the colours and add contrast as well. Down below you can see the before- after result.

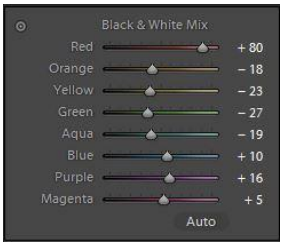




THE B&W SECTION IN THE HSL/COLOR/B&W PANEL

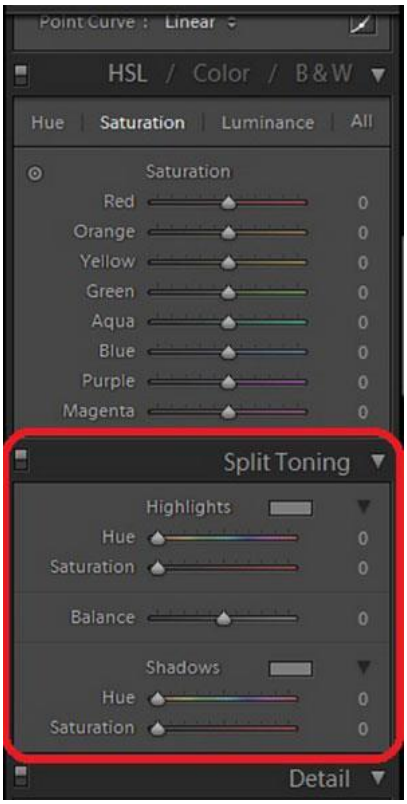
The last tool that we can use to make good black and whites is the B&W panel, which allows us to work on specific channels in the image.
The Black and White tool will automatically bring the saturation of all the channels down allowing you to work on the luminance, in order to create tonal separation.

Down below you can see the before and after version of a picture edited using the B&W tool. As you can see we managed to create more separation of the tones in the image.



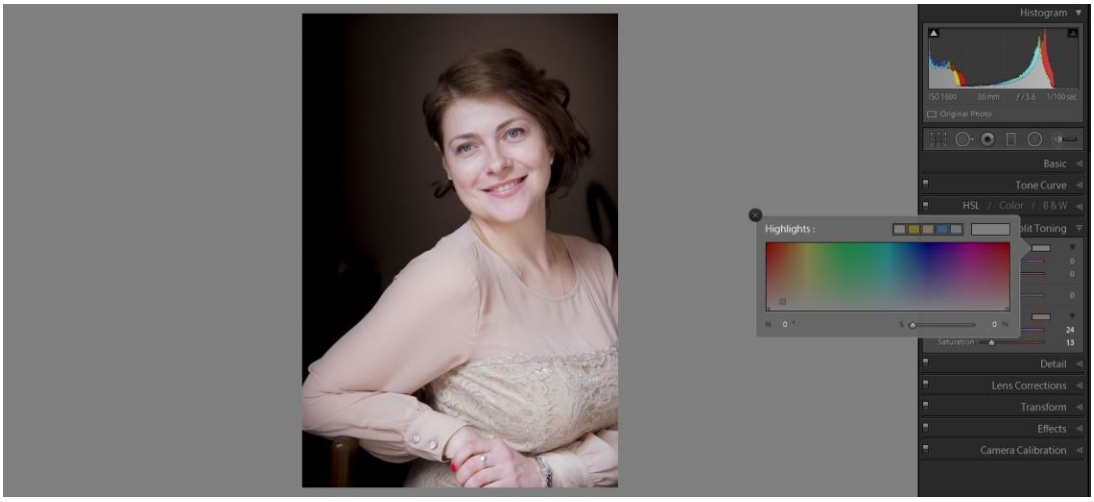
How to Use Lightroom's Split Toning Tool

Lightroom has a lesser known feature called the split toning tool which help create stunning results whether you are shooting landscape, portraits or architecture. The split toning tool adds a colour tone to the highlights and shadows of an image. The tool is found here in the Develop module of Lightroom.



Let’s work together with this image

In order to add some colour to the Highlights, make sure to use the adjustment sliders below and click on the Highlights button to select your Hue and the level of saturation. Alternatively, you can press ALT
+ CLICK (PC) or COMMAND + CLICK (MAC) on the Hue slider to have a preview of the colour that you are going to apply



Then, select your Shadows and choose the colour that you like.

Here below another before – after image where I added some Split toning in the Highlights and Shadows. I chose to add a warm filter for the highlights and a blue filter for the shadows.

How to use the Vignetting

You can find the post-Crop vignetting under your **Effects** tab. The vignette will help you to give a different look to your image and create a centre of attention on the subject, depending on the settings.